According to Van Eekelen,

> Before the final drafts of the texts had been agreed the British and Tibetan delegates completed discussions on the north-eastern border of India, later to be known as the McMahon Line. The Chinese were not invited to take part and their specific acceptance was never sought. They were informed later when the line was embodied in the map annexed to the Convention drawing the borders of Tibet and the boundary between Outer and Inner Tibet.[34]

But if the Chinese and their supporters are to believed, the McMahon Line was indeed the outcome of a conspiracy by McMahon. Chen and his men were kept in the dark, as the British pressured the Tibetans into accepting a new border with British India. Without consulting the Chinese, the border was moved from the foot of the mountains, north of the Brahmaputra, to the crest of the Himalayas. Then, for some unknown reason—perhaps so as to not upset the Chinese—the agreement between the British and the Tibetans was kept secret, or maybe even forgotten, for decades, as Neville Maxwell and Alastair Lamb, among others, allege.

The 1914 Shimla Agreement and the separate Anglo-Tibetan Declaration, which stipulated the McMahon Line, were not mentioned in the 1929 edition of *Aitchison's Treaties*, a collection of 'treaties, engagements and sanads relating to India and neighbouring countries' that was published in a series of volumes beginning in 1862. But, according to Maxwell and Lamb, when the records from the Shimla Conference and the Anglo-Tibetan border agreement were included in a 1938 reissue of the 1929 edition, it also had a 1929 publication date. The original 1929 edition was allegedly withdrawn from circulation.[35] In other words, it was an outright deceit, according to Maxwell and Lamb.

In 1962, the Chinese communist government presented their version of the Shimla conference and its aftermath in a book titled *The Sino-Indian Boundary Question*.

> It was outside the Conference and behind the back of the representatives of the Chinese Central Government that the British representative drew the notorious 'McMahon Line' through a secret exchange of letters with the representative of the Tibet local authorities, attempting thereby to annex 90,000 square kilometres of China's territory to British India. The Chinese Government refused to recognise this illegal McMahon Line. So have all Chinese Governments since then. That is why even the British Government dared not publicly draw this Line on its maps before 1936 [sic]. The illegal McMahon Line was wholly imposed on the Chinese people by British imperialism.[36]